

LITERARY IMPRESARIOS Sanjoy K. Roy, Namita Gokhale and William Dalrymple at a preview of the Jaipur Literature Festival, Jan. 10

LITERATURE

The Great Gathering

*With over 300 speakers across five venues, the **Jaipur Literature Festival** promises an impressive 18th edition*

The Jaipur Literature Festival (JLF), often called the "greatest literary show on Earth", returns for its 18th edition from January 30 to February 3, 2025, at Hotel Clarks Amer in Jaipur. Organised by Teamwork Arts, the Festival is a celebration of literature, bringing together writers, thinkers and readers from across the world. The 2025 edition offers thought-provoking discussions and performances that explore the transformative power of literature.

Over five days, the Festival will feature over 300 speakers across five venues. The line-up includes global literary figures like André Aciman, Jenny Erpenbeck, Venki Ramakrishnan and David Hare, alongside Indian authors such as Geetanjali Shree, Manav Kaul and Aruna Roy. Discussions will cover diverse topics, from memoirs and the intersection of art and politics to the economic ideas shaping the future. Conversations will also explore the legacies of figures like Gandhi and Tolstoy, challenging audiences to reconsider established narratives.

The 2025 Festival will feature sessions in a variety of Indian languages such as Hindi, Bengali, Kannada, Tamil, Telugu, and Rajasthani, alongside English. Namita Gokhale, JLF co-director, highlights how translations help broaden the reach of Indian literature. "Readers are eager to return to their familiar language pools," she says. The presence of international writers, including those from Europe and Ireland, further enriches the Festival's global spirit.

The Jaipur Music Stage, running from January 30 to February 1, will showcase performances from artists like Kailash Kher, Abhijit Pohankar, and Kamakshi Khanna.

The Jaipur BookMark (JBM), now in its 11th edition, serves as a key B2B networking platform, where publishers, authors, and literary agents collaborate to bring creative projects to fruition. As the business arm of the Festival, JBM is a vital space for the global publishing community.



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Sanjoy K. Roy, MD, Teamwork Arts, reflects on JLF's expansive role: "The Festival celebrates the power of arts and ideas to unite us, creating a space where perspectives converge. Even as we expand internationally, the legacy of the Festival remains integral to every edition."

Namita Gokhale captures the Festival's spirit: "We resist echo chambers and showcase diverse voices, especially young ones." William Dalrymple, Festival co-director, calls it "a carnival of literature".

With sessions such as Esther Duflo's *Poor Economics for Kids* and Geetanjali Shree's discussion of her Booker Prize-winning novel *Tomb of Sand*, the 2025 Festival offers something for every literary enthusiast. Whether you're a reader, writer, or cultural explorer, JLF 2025 invites you to engage with leading literary figures and immerse yourself in a global exchange of ideas. ■

–Nikhil Sardana